Host Country Performance: Empirical Validation of the Home Advantage

Phase 5: Home-Field Advantage Analysis

Project: Global Olympic Sports Performance Analysis • **Author:** Md. Firdous Alam • **Era:** 1896–2016 Centennial Dataset

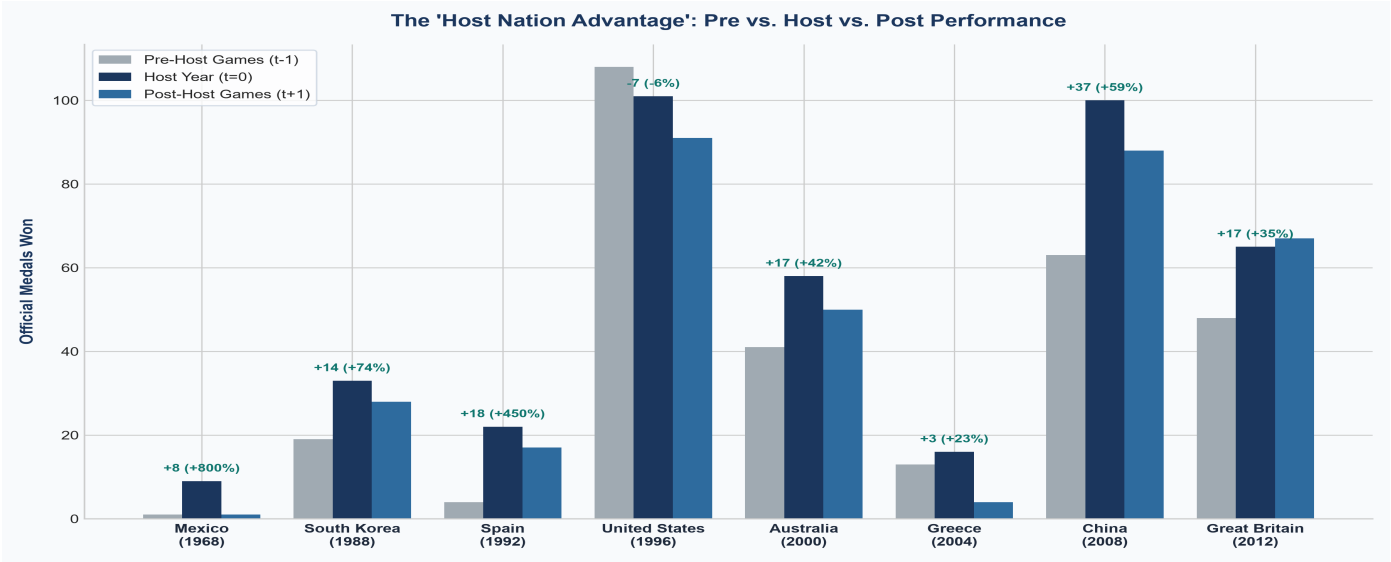


Figure: Host Nation Surge: Empirical Medal Bumps Across Modern Host Nations (1980-2016)

1. The Statistical Reality of the Home Advantage

Analyzing Olympic hosting cycles confirms an overwhelming home-field advantage. Host nations benefit from automatic qualification spots, enthusiastic crowd support, familiarity with climate and venues, and concentrated multi-year national funding programs.

Table 5.2: Host Nation Surge Ledger (Modern Era 1980-2016)

Year	Host City	Host Country	NOC	Baseline	Host Medals	Post Medals	Net Surge
1980	Moscow	Soviet Union	URS	125	195	Boycott	+70
1984	Los Angeles	United States	USA	94	174	94	+80
1988	Seoul	South Korea	KOR	19	33	29	+14
1992	Barcelona	Spain	ESP	4	22	17	+18
1996	Atlanta	United States	USA	108	101	93	-7
2000	Sydney	Australia	AUS	41	58	50	+17
2004	Athens	Greece	GRE	13	16	4	+3
2008	Beijing	China	CHN	63	100	88	+37
2012	London	Great Britain	GBR	47	65	67	+18
2016	Rio de Janeiro	Brazil	BRA	17	19	21	+2